THOMAS HOWARD

CTO & Head of Applied AI

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SUMMARY

I build AI agents that do real work, and the controls that make them safe to trust. I also own the strategy around them: what to build, for whom, and what has to be true before it ships. I'm at my best where strategy and hands-on work meet: deciding what an agent should be allowed to do, building it, and proving it's right.

EXPERIENCE

CTO & Head of Applied AI, Snap eHealth

Jun 2026 – Present

Promoted to CTO to own AI strategy, product, and engineering delivery for our agent platform, while remaining the company's hands-on AI engineer.

STRATEGY & LEADERSHIP

- Set the AI roadmap with the CEO and partner directly with CIOs, CTOs, CEOs and board executives at enterprise clients to turn business requirements into product requirements and agentic design patterns.
- Launched four products (Sally, Referral Intelligence, VBC360, Workflows) as one Value-Based Care platform on the athenahealth Marketplace, sized at ~$30K in added annual revenue per practice and a $9M annual revenue opportunity.
- Led launch strategy through staged pilot cohorts, starting with ~75 patients at OnPoint Medical Group and validating outcomes before scaling; 14 groups are scheduled to onboard after the new year.
- Direct a lean engineering team through speed-versus-stability trade-offs, consolidating infrastructure onto one cloud platform with continuous daily deployments; train our senior engineer in AI-assisted development.

HANDS-ON

- Built Sally, a production healthcare voice agent: the LLM handles intent and conversation, while deterministic state machines handle consent, identity verification, and anything that changes a record.
- Designed a 180-scenario evaluation and release gate, run 20 times per scenario, that surfaced a call-termination failure in 40% of runs and reached 3,600/3,600 passes.
- Defined fallback behavior for timeouts, hang-ups, off-topic requests, and tool errors, with deterministic logic for anything outside the agent's scope.
- Delivered four agent applications in four months with Symphony, my governed multi-agent coding system, now serving ~1,200 users across four clinics with zero production incidents.

Head of AI Product Strategy & Platform, Snap eHealth

Oct 2022 – Jun 2026

Drove product roadmap alignment and executive buy-in for enterprise AI transformation, managing scope trade-offs and risk frameworks across multi-stakeholder initiatives, while building the AI platform hands-on.

STRATEGY & LEADERSHIP

- Defined user stories and operational requirements for multi-agent control planes, specifying deterministic triage logic, automated safety gates, and human escalation pathways.
- Established product evaluation standards on Amazon Bedrock, leading the creation of goldset benchmark suites and guardrails to minimize model drift and ensure enterprise compliance.
- Defined product specifications for explainable machine learning ranking systems, ensuring transparent scoring models, precision metrics, and automated abstention protocols.

HANDS-ON

- Designed and built an AI engineering control plane: specialized monitoring, security, and SRE agents producing structured evidence, with deterministic triage, bounded remediation, protected verification gates, and human escalation.

- Built an AI test-intelligence system that decomposed product stories, generated test requirements and API tests, analyzed defects, and targeted retests.
- Architected an explainable physician-referral ranking engine in Python and scikit-learn, combining clinical quality, outcomes, eligibility, availability, and proximity with deterministic scoring, uncertainty handling, and abstention.
- Developing supervised models to predict 30-day referral completion, with leakage prevention and evaluation on precision, recall, ROC-AUC, and calibration.

Founder & Product Lead, BusyNow (busynow.app) Oct 2025 – Present

Designed and built Symphony, an autonomous coding-agent runner based on OpenAI's open-source Symphony specification, and used it to develop BusyNow: defining the workflow for task intake, isolated execution, CI/CD validation, and human review of every pull request before merge.

- Used real-time user telemetry and traffic analytics to validate the core hypothesis, growing to about 1,000 users a month within two months with no marketing spend.
- Oversee end-to-end cloud product architecture, managing vendor integrations, rate limits, provider budgets, and deployment reliability strategies.
- Identified a key market gap in local venue discovery, founding and launching a real-time data product across Seattle and New York based on validated user pain points.
- Designed predictable execution models and audit mechanisms, prioritizing failure predictability, cost management, and system transparency over raw parallelism.

Director of Engineering, FBS Jan 2015 – Apr 2022

Managed a 12-person organization within a 60-engineer company, driving product strategy, hiring, roadmap delivery, and technical governance for the nationwide Flexmls platform.

- Led a multi-year platform migration strategy from legacy PHP to modern Ruby on Rails and JavaScript architectures while maintaining continuous service availability for the customer base.
- Reduced regression release cycle times by 90% by championing an automation-first culture, standardized quality controls, and early validation processes.
- Managed developer tooling, CI/CD pipelines, and cloud observability platforms as internal products to accelerate developer productivity across the wider engineering organization.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer, Google Jun 2012 – Dec 2014

Software Engineer, Community Health Plan of Washington Aug 2011 – Jun 2012

Software Engineer, Xperience Communications Aug 2010 – Aug 2011

SKILLS

Product Leadership: technical product strategy, zero-to-one product roadmap execution, agent task decomposition, scope reduction, eval-driven release criteria, executive & technical stakeholder management

AI & Agent Platforms: conversational & voice agent product management, multi-agent orchestration, tool integration, context engineering, structured outputs, Amazon Bedrock, Codex

Eval & Governance: agent evaluations, goldset benchmark creation, regression harnesses, safety guardrails, deterministic verification, human-in-the-loop approval workflows

Technical Architecture: Python, Go, TypeScript, React, Node.js/Express, REST APIs, PostgreSQL, Redis, scikit-learn, system design, enterprise integrations

Cloud & Operations: AWS (ECS, Bedrock, IAM, VPC), Terraform, Docker, CI/CD pipelines, product telemetry & observability, release management

EDUCATION

Harvard University, Harvard Extension School | Special Student, on-campus courses in Harvard College | GPA 3.9